

4.5 Static variables

PHP provides some Static variables which exist only in a local function scope. The Static variables do not loose their value in case the function (where they are declared) execution is terminated and is recalled later. Static variables can be used for working with recursive functions, where a function calls itself.

Example 1:

```
<?php
$abc = 9;
function fruit () {
    static $abc = 0;
    $fruit_arr =
array("mango","apple","guava","bananna");
    $abc++;
    $abc %= count($fruit_arr);
    return $fruit_arr[$abc];
}
for ($j=0; $j<10; $j++) {
    print "What's for dinner - ".fruit()."?"<br />";
}
print $abc; # Just to show you this is a different abc!
?>
```

The output of this program is:

```
Which fruit you like - apple?
Which fruit you like - guava?
Which fruit you like - bananna?
Which fruit you like - mango?
Which fruit you like - apple?
Which fruit you like - guava?
Which fruit you like - bananna?
Which fruit you like - mango?
Which fruit you like - apple?
Which fruit you like - guava?
9
```